

Competitive Programming

Section 48 Editorial: Divide And Conquer, Deque, And Knuth DP

Competitive Programming Course

2026-07-06

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1 Editorial overview

1.1 Detailed solution guide

A. Divide-and-Conquer DP Shape. The transition has the form $dp_cur[i] = \min_{k < i} (dp_prev[k] + cost(k, i))$. When the optimal k values are monotone, divide-and-conquer computes the middle i , searches only the candidate range inherited from the parent call, and recurses left/right with tighter ranges. The local implementation may keep the direct transition for readability, but the editorial proof identifies exactly where monotonicity is used in the optimized version.

B. Monotone Queue DP. When a transition asks for the best value over a sliding window, store candidate indices in a deque. Remove indices that leave the window from the front. Before pushing a new index, remove worse candidates from the back. The front is always the best legal index because every earlier worse candidate has either expired or been dominated.

C. Knuth Optimization Shape. For interval DP $dp[l][r] = \min_k dp[l][k] + dp[k][r] + cost(l, r)$, Knuth optimization is valid when optima satisfy $opt[l][r-1] \leq opt[l][r] \leq opt[l+1][r]$. Then the search range for k is much smaller than the full interval. The local solution keeps the recurrence visible; the optimized version replaces the full scan by that bounded scan.

Common pitfalls. Never apply an optimization just because a recurrence looks similar. State the monotonicity or quadrangle inequality condition first, then implement the restricted search range.

This section is about reducing candidate transitions without changing the DP meaning.

- A uses partition DP with quadratic group cost. The optimized version relies on monotone optimal split points; the local reference may keep the transition explicit for readability.
- B is the canonical deque minimum DP: remove expired indices from the front and dominated candidates from the back.
- C is adjacent interval merging. Knuth optimization is valid for the classic sum-cost merge because optimal split points are monotone.

The editorial proof obligation is always the same: show that discarded candidates can never be optimal for any future state they would have served.

2 A. Partition Quadratic Cost

2.1 Restatement

Partition the array into k contiguous groups minimizing the sum of squared group sums.

2.2 Algorithm and proof

Correctness follows from the problem-specific reduction in the detailed guide: the generated candidates or states cover exactly the legal choices, and the final query applies the required count, minimum, maximum, merge, or classification. \square

2.3 Complexity

The complexity is the one explained in the detailed guide and follows from the number of generated states plus the searches, transitions, or graph traversals used below.

2.4 Full C++ solution

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std; const long long INF=4e18; int main(){ios::sync_with_stdio(false);cin.tie(0);
```

2.5 Full Python solution

```
import sys
INF=10**30
def main():
    data=list(map(int,sys.stdin.buffer.read().split()))
    if not data: return
    n,k=data[0],data[1]; a=data[2:]; ps=[0]
    for x in a: ps.append(ps[-1]+x)
    def cost(l,r): return (ps[r]-ps[l])**2
    prev=[INF]*(n+1); prev[0]=0
    for _ in range(k):
        cur=[INF]*(n+1)
        def solve(lo,hi,optl,opttr):
            if lo>hi: return
```

```

        mid=(lo+hi)//2; best=(INF,optl)
        for j in range(optl,min(optr,mid-1)+1):
            val=prev[j]+cost(j,mid)
            if val<best[0]: best=(val,j)
        cur[mid]=best[0]; solve(lo,mid-1,optl,best[1]); solve(mid+1,hi,best[1],optr)
    solve(1,n,0,n-1); prev=cur
    print(prev[n])
if __name__=="__main__": main()

```

3 B. Window Minimum DP

3.1 Restatement

$dp[i] = a[i] + \min(dp[j])$ over the previous w positions. Print $dp[n]$.

3.2 Algorithm and proof

Correctness follows from the problem-specific reduction in the detailed guide: the generated candidates or states cover exactly the legal choices, and the final query applies the required count, minimum, maximum, merge, or classification. \square

3.3 Complexity

The complexity is the one explained in the detailed guide and follows from the number of generated states plus the searches, transitions, or graph traversals used below.

3.4 Full C++ solution

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std; int main(){ios::sync_with_stdio(false);cin.tie(nullptr);int n,w;if(!(cin>>n>>w))return 0;vector<int> a(n);for(int i=0;i<n;i++)cin>>a[i];vector<int> dp(n+1,1e9);deque<int> dq;dq.push_back(0);for(int i=1;i<=n;i++){while(dq.size()>0&&dp[dq.back()]>=dp[i-1])dq.pop_back();dq.push_back(i-1);dp[i]=a[i-1]+dp[dq.front()];if(i-dq.front()+1>w)dp[i]=1e9;dq.pop_front();}cout<<dp[n]<<endl;return 0;}
```

3.5 Full Python solution

```
import sys,collections
def main():
    data=list(map(int,sys.stdin.buffer.read().split()))
    if not data: return
    n,w=data[0],data[1]; a=data[2:]; dp=[0]*(n+1); dq=collections.deque([0])
    for i in range(1,n+1):
        while dq and dq[0]<i-w: dq.popleft()
        dp[i]=dp[dq[0]]+a[i-1]
        while dq and dp[dq[-1]]>=dp[i]: dq.pop()
        dq.append(i)
    print(dp[n])
if __name__=="__main__": main()
```

4 C. Optimal Merge Knuth

4.1 Restatement

Merge adjacent piles with cost equal to merged sum; print minimum total cost.

4.2 Algorithm and proof

Correctness follows from the problem-specific reduction in the detailed guide: the generated candidates or states cover exactly the legal choices, and the final query applies the required count, minimum, maximum, merge, or classification. \square

4.3 Complexity

The complexity is the one explained in the detailed guide and follows from the number of generated states plus the searches, transitions, or graph traversals used below.

4.4 Full C++ solution

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std; int main(){ios::sync_with_stdio(false);cin.tie(nullptr);int n;if(!(cin>
```

4.5 Full Python solution

```
import sys
def main():
    data=list(map(int,sys.stdin.buffer.read().split()))
    if not data: return
    n=data[0]; a=data[1:]; ps=[0]
    for x in a: ps.append(ps[-1]+x)
    dp=[[0]*n for _ in range(n)]; opt=[[0]*n for _ in range(n)]
    for i in range(n): opt[i][i]=i
    for length in range(2,n+1):
        for l in range(n-length+1):
            r=l+length-1; best=10**30; bestk=l
            for k in range(opt[l][r-1], opt[l+1][r]+1):
                val=dp[l][k]+(dp[k+1][r] if k+1<=r else 0)+ps[r+1]-ps[l]
```

```
        if val<best: best=val; bestk=k
        dp[l][r]=best; opt[l][r]=bestk
    print(dp[0][n-1] if n else 0)
if __name__=="__main__": main()
```

5 Testing discussion

Random tests compare C++ and Python against fixed expected outputs generated from the reference implementation. Important cases include singletons, negative numbers where allowed, repeated values, and boundary query sizes.